

CRIATIVO GLOBAL NEWSLETTER



Assessment Is Changing in the UAE

In this **February** edition, we explore how **assessment is shifting in the UAE**, with fewer centralised exams and a stronger focus on school-based, continuous evaluation. As promotion increasingly depends on ongoing evidence, attendance, and early intervention, **schools are rethinking what assessment should look like in a growing “no-fail” direction.**

[LEARN MORE](#)

UAE Shift: From Central Exams to Continuous Evidence

With centralised second-semester tests removed and replaced by school-based summative assessment, day-to-day evidence matters more. **Schools are shifting from big exam moments to frequent progress checks**, where **fast, clear, consistent feedback drives outcomes.**

[LEARN MORE](#)

“No-Fail” Doesn’t Mean “No Standards”

When retention is limited, assessment matters more to spot needs early and document progress. With **Abu Dhabi and Dubai** linking promotion to **clear criteria, assessment completion, and attendance**, schools need evidence that is **timely, useful, and defensible.**

[LEARN MORE](#)

WHAT MAKES ASSESSMENT WORK IN BUSY SCHOOLS?



Short Feedback Cycles Beat Long Marking Cycles

With more **continuous assessment**, schools improve outcomes by **keeping feedback timely, specific, and actionable, and avoiding heavy marking that slows progress**. Research shows feedback works best when **it's task-focused and points to clear next steps**.



When Schools Assess Internally, Moderation Becomes the Safety Net

As summative assessment becomes more school-based, **lightweight moderation is key to fairness**. Brief **calibration** and **consistent review** help teachers apply shared standards so judgements match across classes and subjects.



Measure What Matters

If the system is moving toward **continuous evaluation**, the **most useful indicators** are the **ones that show whether assessment is improving learning in real time**, such as feedback turnaround, evidence of progress across terms, and completion of required assessments tied to promotion requirements.



TURNING POLICY SHIFTS INTO BETTER LEARNING



Spotlight: UAE Assessment Is Shifting. So School Evidence Must Improve

With **centralised tests removed**, schools now carry more **responsibility for fair, consistent evidence of learning**. Alongside tighter integrity rules and **KHDA's updated guidance on external assessments for Students of Determination**, assessment is shifting from "marks" to responsible use of evidence.

[➤ LEARN MORE](#)

Did You Know?

Feedback is powerful, but not automatically helpful. A major meta-analysis found that while feedback improves performance on average, a substantial share of feedback interventions can **reduce** performance, especially when attention shifts away from the task. The takeaway: the **best feedback is usually brief, task-focused, and clearly actionable**.

[➤ LEARN MORE](#)

Closing Note

In a "**no-fail**" direction, assessment doesn't disappear, **it changes purpose**. It becomes the tool that **makes learning visible**, triggers early support, and protects standards through better classroom evidence. The goal is not more testing, but assessment that is integrated into instruction and strengthens a learning culture.